Skippy for Android User Guide

Install and use the Skippy phone app - app version 1.19.2

Skippy for Android puts the Skippy group video calls on your phone: log in, join rooms of up to 10 people, call one person directly, chat and send files. It is a **client only** - it connects to the same Skippy server your desktop app uses, so you need that server's address and an account on it.

What you need

- An Android phone, **Android 7.0 or newer**, with a camera and microphone.
- The **server address** from whoever runs your Skippy server, for example **100.64.0.10:8470**.
- If that address starts with **100.** it is a Tailscale address: install the **Tailscale** app on the phone, sign in to the same account as the server and switch it on. Without it the phone cannot reach the server.
- The file **Skippy-Android-1.19.2.apk** from the **latest release** at github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases (the one release page holds the files for every platform).

> **Not from the Play Store.** This app is installed by hand ("sideloading"). Android will warn you about installing from outside the store - that is normal. Only install the file from the official release page.

Install - choose one method

Method A: install on the phone itself (easiest)

1. On the phone, open the browser and go to **github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases**. Open the **latest release** and tap **Skippy-Android-1.19.2.apk** in its list of files to download it.
2. When the download finishes tap **Open** (or find it in the **Files** or **Downloads** app and tap it).
3. Android says it can't install apps from this source: tap **Settings** and switch on **Allow from this source** for the browser or Files app you used, then press Back.
4. Tap **Install**. If Google Play Protect says it hasn't seen the app before, tap **More details**, then **Install anyway**.
5. Tap **Open**. Skippy is now in your app list too.

Method B: install from a Windows PC over USB with adb

Useful if you also do development, and the best way to update later (one command).

1. On the phone open **Settings, About phone** and tap **Build number** seven times to unlock Developer options. Then open **Settings, System, Developer options** and switch on **USB debugging**.
2. Connect the phone to the PC with a USB cable. Unlock the phone and tap **Allow** on the "Allow USB debugging?" prompt (tick *Always allow*).
3. On the PC, with the Android **platform-tools** installed, open a command prompt in the folder with the APK and run:

```
adb devices
adb install -r Skippy-Android-1.19.2.apk
```

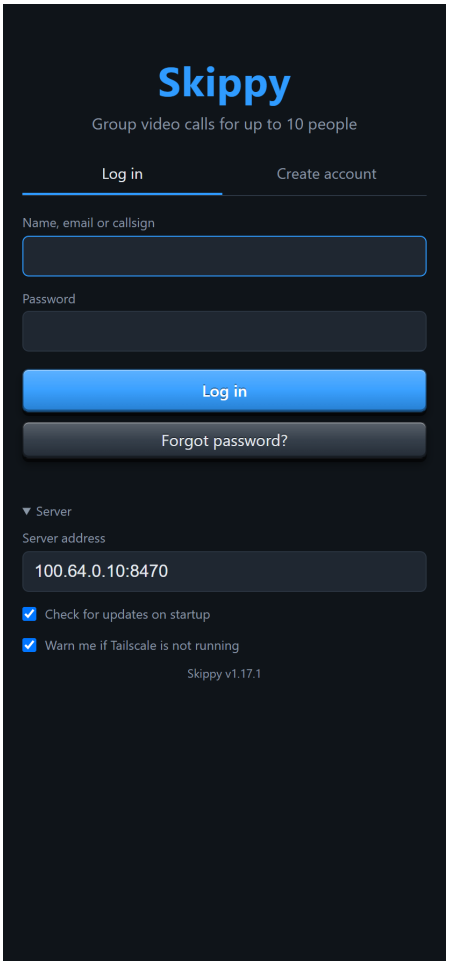
adb devices must list your phone as *device*; **Success** means it installed. **-r** keeps your login and settings when you update.

Method C: copy the file over USB

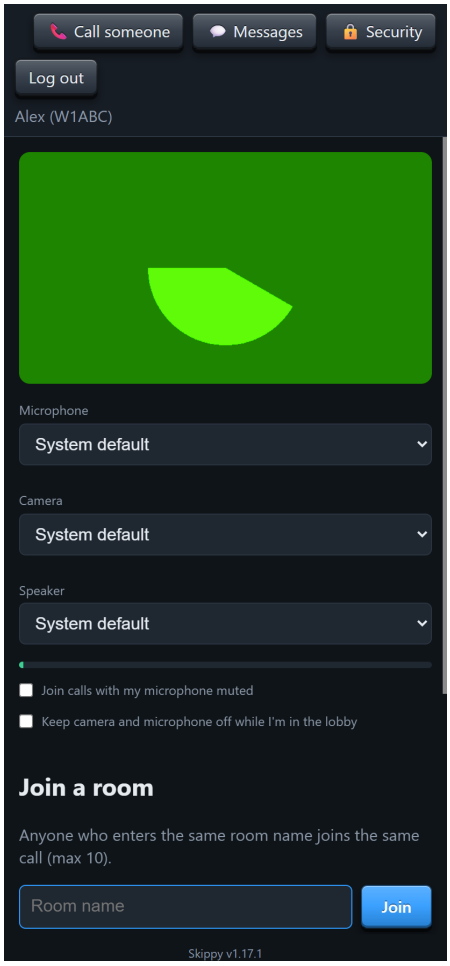
Download the APK on the PC, connect the phone with a cable, choose **File transfer** in the USB notification, copy the APK to the phone's **Download** folder, then open it from the **Files** app and continue from step 3 of Method A.

First start

1. Open **Skippy**. On the login screen open **Server** and type the server address (the **ws://** at the front is optional).
2. New here? Tap **Create account**, fill in name, email, optional callsign and a password of 8 or more characters. Existing account: log in with your name, email or callsign.
3. Skippy shows a **recovery key** once - save it somewhere safe. It is the only way back in if you forget your password.
4. When Android asks to let Skippy use the **camera** and **microphone**, allow both (while using the app is enough).



Enter the server address under **Server**.

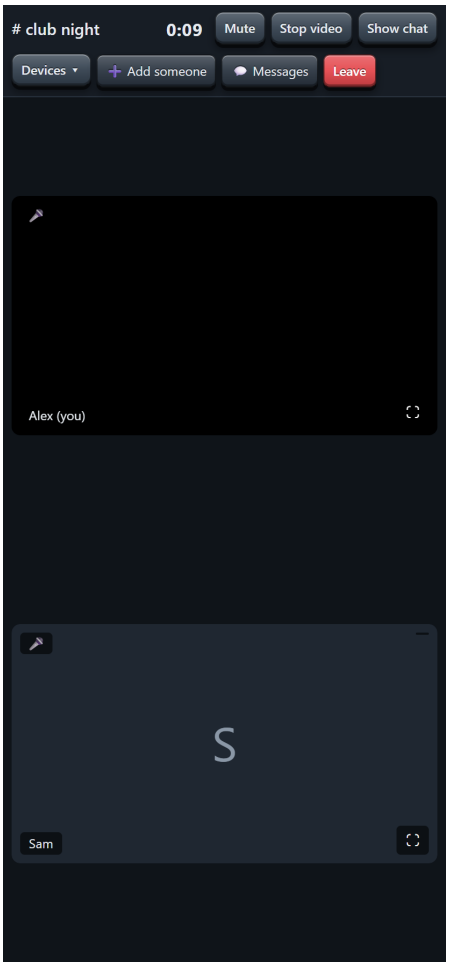


The lobby: preview, devices, room name and who is online.

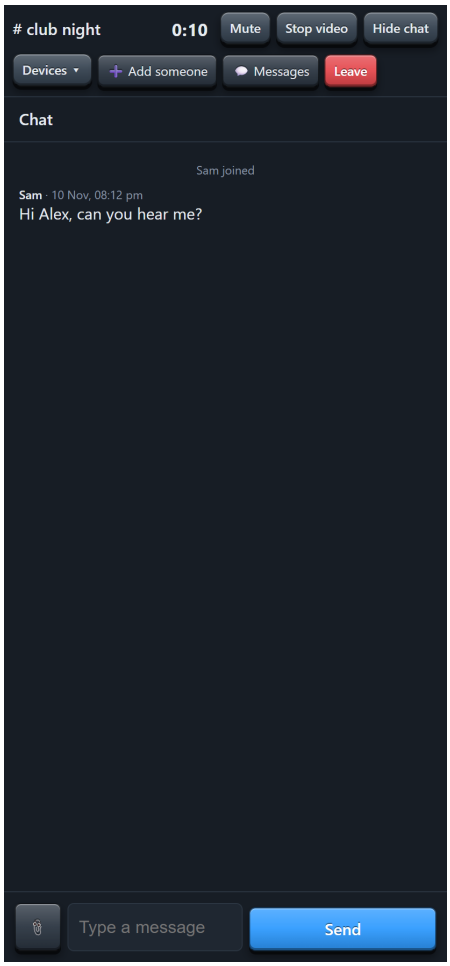
If you turned on a two-step code (authenticator app) on the desktop, the phone asks for it after your password. To set it up from the phone, open **Security** in the lobby: instead of a QR code it shows the secret and an **Open in my authenticator app** link.

Using Skippy on the phone

To do this	Do this
Join or start a room	Type a room name in the lobby and tap **Join**, or tap a room in the open or recent lists.
Call one person	Tap **Call someone** (lobby) or **Add someone** (in a call) and pick them from the list.
Mute / camera off	**Mute** and **Stop video** at the top of the call screen.
Pick or switch camera and microphone	**Devices** in the call (or the lists in the lobby): choose the front or back camera.
Fill the screen with one person	Double-tap their tile, or tap the corner button on it.
Chat	**Show chat** opens the chat over the call; **Hide chat** brings the video back.
Send a file	In the chat tap the paperclip and choose a file. Everyone in the call at that moment receives it.
Save a received file	Tap **Save** next to the file; it goes to **Documents/Skippy** on the phone.
Leave	Tap **Leave**.



In a call: video tiles fill the screen, controls on top.



Chat opens over the call.

Keep Skippy open on the screen during a call. The screen stays awake while you are in a call. The phone version has no background mode, and it **does not ring when the app is closed** - people can call you only while Skippy is open.

Different from the desktop app

- No **screen sharing** and no **call recording / transcripts** on the phone.

- No window arranging: video tiles are laid out automatically.
- No Tailscale warning banner - the phone can't check Tailscale for you, so turn it on yourself.

Updating

Download the newer APK and install it over the old one (Method A, or **adb install -r**); your login and settings are kept. If Android says **App not installed** or a conflict, the new file was signed with a different key: uninstall Skippy first (you will need to log in again) and install the new one.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Call to another phone stays on *connecting*	Both phones on different networks need the server's media relay: the server must be version 1.19.2 or newer (update the server, then log out and in on the phones) and allow UDP port 3478 in its firewall. Both phones need Tailscale on.
"Could not reach the server"	Turn on **Tailscale** on the phone and make sure it shows connected. Check the address and port (for example 100.64.0.10:8470) and that the server program is running on its PC.
No video or sound from me	Settings, Apps, Skippy, Permissions: allow **Camera** and **Microphone**. Also check **Mute** and **Stop video** aren't on.
I can't hear others	Raise the media volume; check the phone isn't on silent or routed to a Bluetooth device.
Install blocked	Allow **Install unknown apps** for the browser or Files app you opened the APK from (Method A, step 3). If Play Protect blocks it, choose **Install anyway**.
A received file can't be saved	Tap **Save** again; files go to **Documents/Skippy** (or the app's own storage folder if Android refuses). Very large files are best received on the desktop app.
Forgot my password	Use **Forgot password?** on the login screen with your recovery key.

Skippy for Android shares its code with the desktop app (v1.19.2); the desktop User Guide covers accounts, rooms and the server in more detail. Source and releases: github.com/lrizio/Skippy.